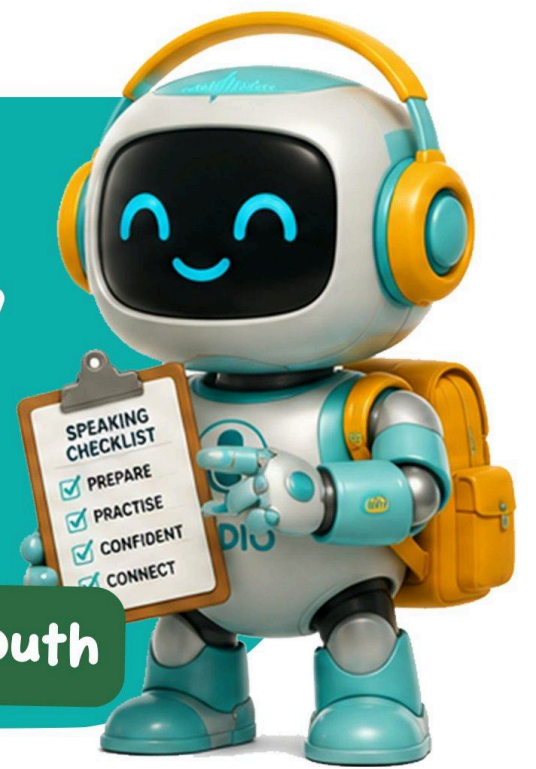


Sparks and the Body Language Code

What Your Body Says Before You Open Your Mouth



PODIO SPEAK™ Power Unlocked: E: Express Yourself • S: Speak Clearly

THE STORY

Sparks had a problem. Even when Sparks said all the right words, something was going wrong.



"You sound like you are reading a dictionary," Leo said, not unkindly. "Even when you say exciting things, your face is completely flat. Your arms hang like wet spaghetti. I am getting confused are you happy to be here or not?"

Sparks was puzzled. "But I am saying the right things! Every word in my speech is correct!"



Chapter Five: Wizzy and the Listening Superpower

Wizzy perched on a nearby branch. "Sparks, scientists have found that when we communicate, words carry only 7% of our message. Our tone of voice carries 38%. But our body language our face, posture, gestures, eye contact carries 55%."



"Fifty-five percent?!" Sparks gasped. "That means most of what I am communicating, I am not even saying?"

Sparks spent the afternoon practising in front of a mirror. Standing tall. Making eye contact. Smiling. Using hands to emphasise words. Moving with purpose.

The next day, Sparks gave the EXACT same speech. Same words. Different body.



Chapter Five: Wizzy and the Listening Superpower

The audience reaction was completely different.

They leaned forward. They laughed. They clapped.

Sparks looked at Wize in amazement. "Same speech!"

"Yes," said Wizzy. "But now the whole of you is speaking."

THE LESSON

What Leo has Taught Us

Use EVERY part of your body when you communicate:

 **POSTURE:** Stand tall. Shoulders back. Chin parallel to the floor. This signals confidence.

 **EYE CONTACT:** Look at your audience. Move your gaze around. Do not stare at one person for too long scan the whole room!

 **GESTURES:** Use your hands! Point, open your palms, count on your fingers. Gestures make your message memorable.

 **FACIAL EXPRESSIONS:** Your face should match your words. Excited? Let your face show it. Serious? Be still.

 **MOVEMENT:** Move with purpose. Walk to a new spot when starting a new idea. Stand still for your most important point.

FUN FACT

Did You Know?

Research by psychologist Albert Mehrabian found that when communicating feelings and attitudes, 55% of the message comes from body language, 38% from tone of voice, and only 7% from the actual words. This is why you can sometimes tell when someone is upset even if they say they are fine!



⚡ MINI CHALLENGE ⚡

The Silent Message Experiment

Without saying a word, try to communicate these feelings to a family member or friend using ONLY your body language: Happy. Excited. Sad. Confused. Angry. Proud.

Can they guess correctly each time? Switch roles and see if you can read THEIR body language. This game will transform your awareness!

SPEAKING MISSION

Mission 6: The Mirror Speech

Give your Chapter 2 speech (or any speech you know) in front of a mirror but this time, focus entirely on your body language. Do not worry about the words. Focus on: posture, eye contact, gestures, facial expressions, and movement. Record yourself if possible and watch it back!



REFLECTION QUESTION

Watch a speech or presentation online a TED Talk for kids, a famous speech, or even a sports coach interview. What body language techniques do you notice them using? Which ones would you like to try?





COMMUNICATION BADGE UNLOCKED!



Badge: THE BODY LANGUAGE MASTER

You earn this badge when you complete the Mirror Speech and can identify at least 3 body language techniques you used deliberately.



PARENT CORNER



Dear Parent or Carer: Chapter 6 Summary

What your child learned:

Chapter 6 introduced non-verbal communication: the posture, eye contact, gestures, and facial expressions that carry more than half of every message. Your child is now learning to make their whole body speak not just their words.

Activity to try:

Watch a favourite TV presenter or public figure together and discuss their body language. Ask: How do they use their hands? What does their posture say about their confidence? When do they use eye contact most effectively? Making these observations together builds your child's communication intelligence.